



WATCH DOG
ENERGY MANAGEMENT
Customer User Guide

Watch Every Watt

Document	Details
Software release	2.2.1
Guide edition	September 2026
Audience	Mall operators, billing staff and administrators
Prepared by	MicroBrain by Fadi Assi

Purpose Operate, monitor and bill reliably from one Watch Dog installation. Screens show fictional demonstration data; site values will differ.

Customer copy • Keep near the main Watch Dog PC

Contents

A practical route from commissioning through monitoring, billing and support.

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Terminology The current interface says **Grid** for utility electricity. “UMEME” was the name used by earlier releases.

System at a glance

What Watch Dog does—and what remains in the field meter.

How Watch Dog turns meter readings into invoices

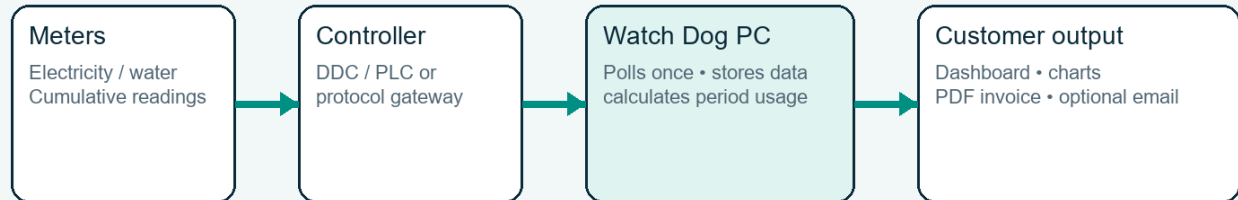


Figure 1 — End-to-end operating model

What the system does

- Reads cumulative utility values supplied by commissioned meters through Modbus RTU or Modbus TCP gateways.
- Stores time-stamped readings in one local database, shows status and consumption trends, and calculates billing-period consumption.
- Applies the tariff saved for each meter, publishes monthly invoices, and keeps a searchable invoice archive.
- Optionally emails the published PDF invoice through the customer's own SMTP service.

Important Watch Dog does not replace a certified energy meter and does not calculate the physical energy quantity. Billing is based on the reliable cumulative reading received from the meter.

Start, sign in and navigate

The same application is used on the main PC and authorized browser clients.

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Main Settings Register Login

SECURE ACCESS

Administrator login

Enter an Administrator account to switch this session to Administrator level.

Switch to Administrator

Administrator username Password

Enter Administrator level

This replaces the current signed-in session with the selected Administrator account. Bootstrap is only used once when a new installation has no Administrator.

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Figure 2 — Administrator sign-in from the current page

Start and sign in

On the main PC, start Watch Dog Energy Management using the installed shortcut or configured startup method.

Wait for the browser to open at <http://localhost:5080>.

Use the Administrator level link when configuration is required, then enter the assigned username and password.

Use Main for operational pages and Settings for administrator pages. Log out when finished.

Access levels Administrator: full setup. Billing Manager: tariffs, invoices and payments. Operator: monitoring and routine operations. Viewer: read-only monitoring. Visible pages depend on the signed-in role.

Dashboard

One operational view of electricity meters, invoices and system condition.

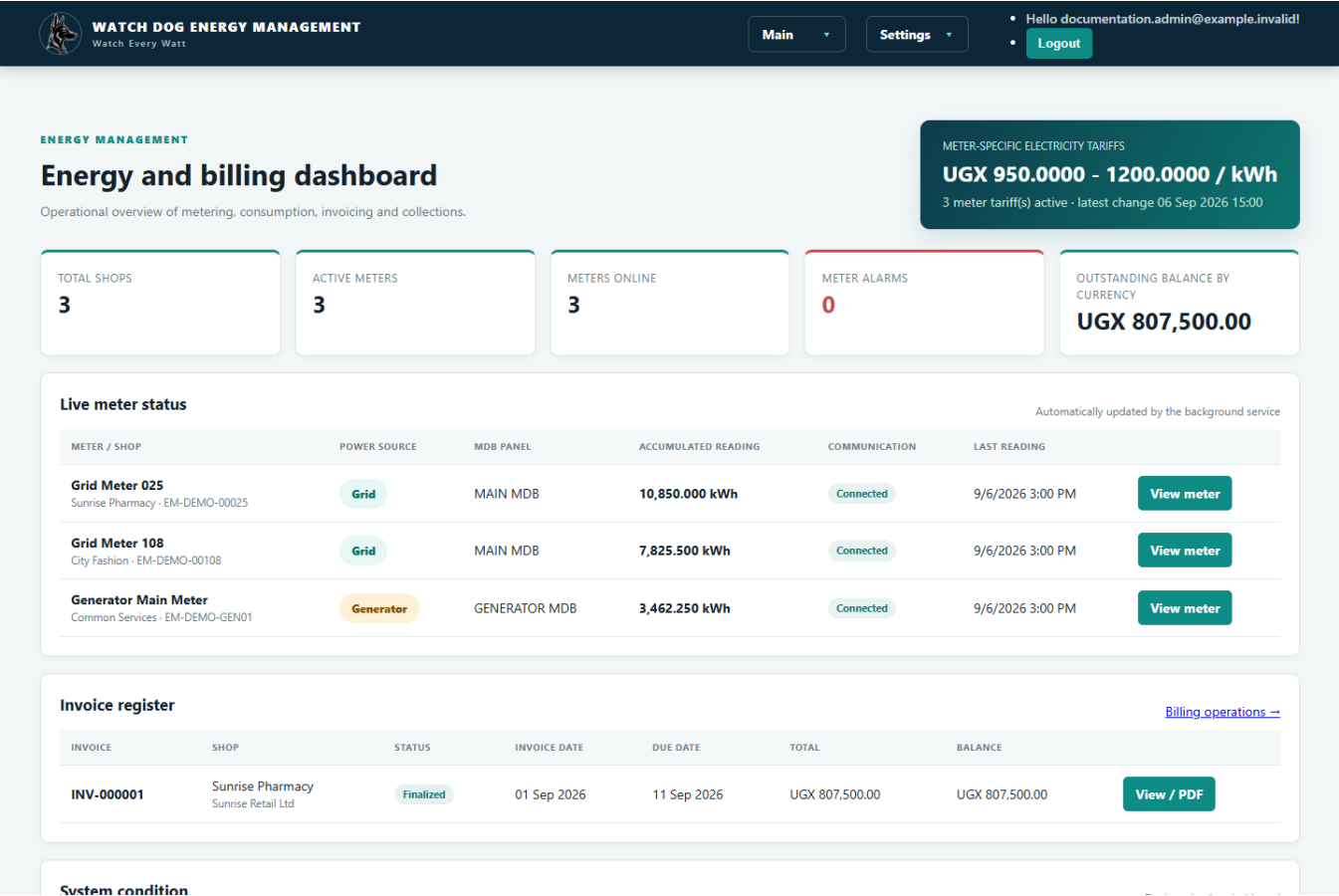


Figure 3 — Dashboard with fictional demonstration data

Area	How to use it
Summary cards	Check shops, active meters, meters online, alarms and outstanding balances.
Tariff banner	Confirms the range and count of active meter-specific electricity tariffs.
Live meter status	Shows Grid/Generator source, MDB panel, accumulated reading, communication state and last-reading time.
Invoice register	Opens recent invoices and their PDF/detail page.
System condition	Use status totals to decide whether to investigate communication or billing.

Healthy reading “Connected” plus a recent Last reading time is the strongest quick check. A value that never changes may still be a valid low-load period; compare timestamps and the physical meter before changing settings.

Grid and Generator pages

Source-specific electricity monitoring with the same search and meter workflow.

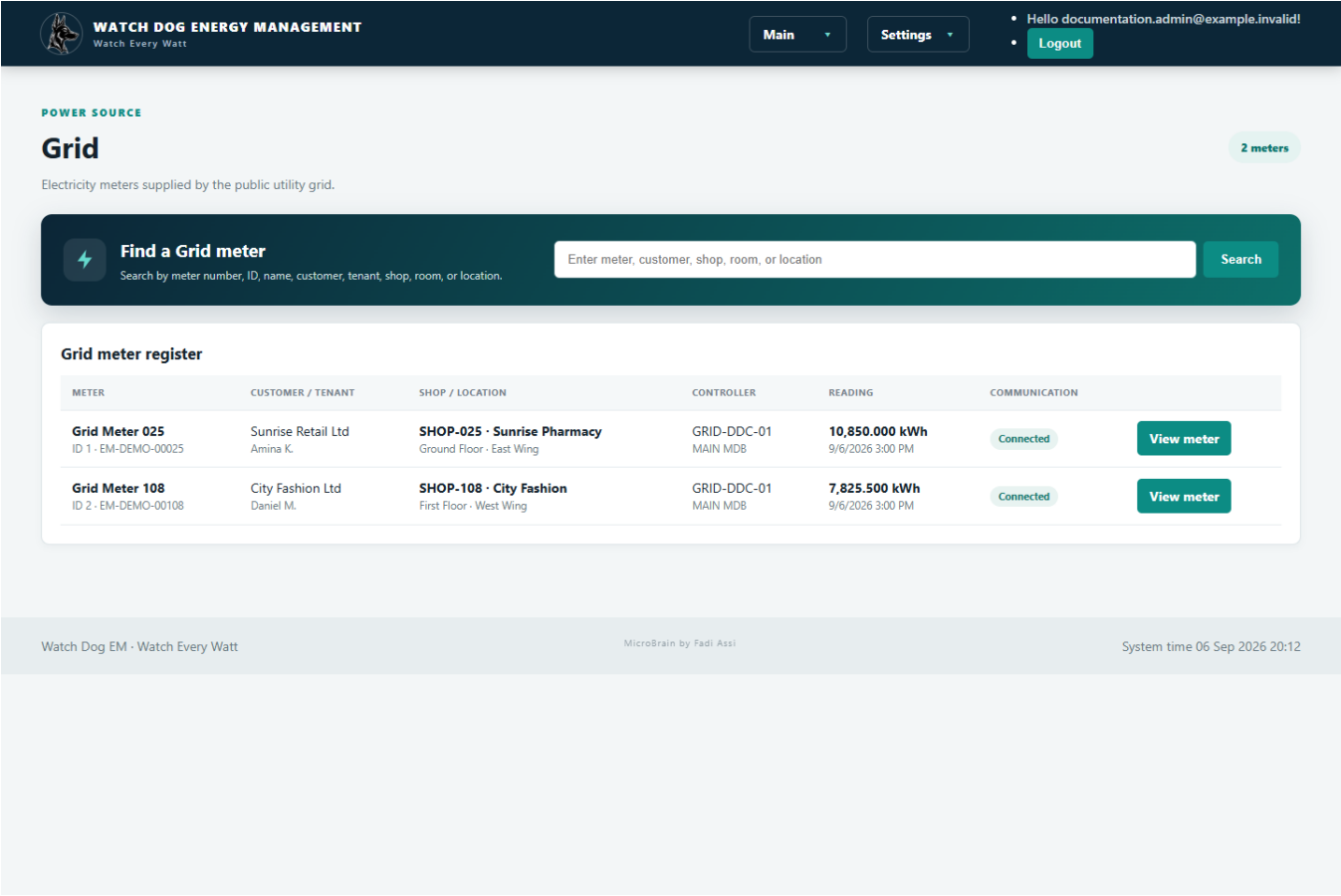


Figure 4 — Grid page: only utility-supply meters

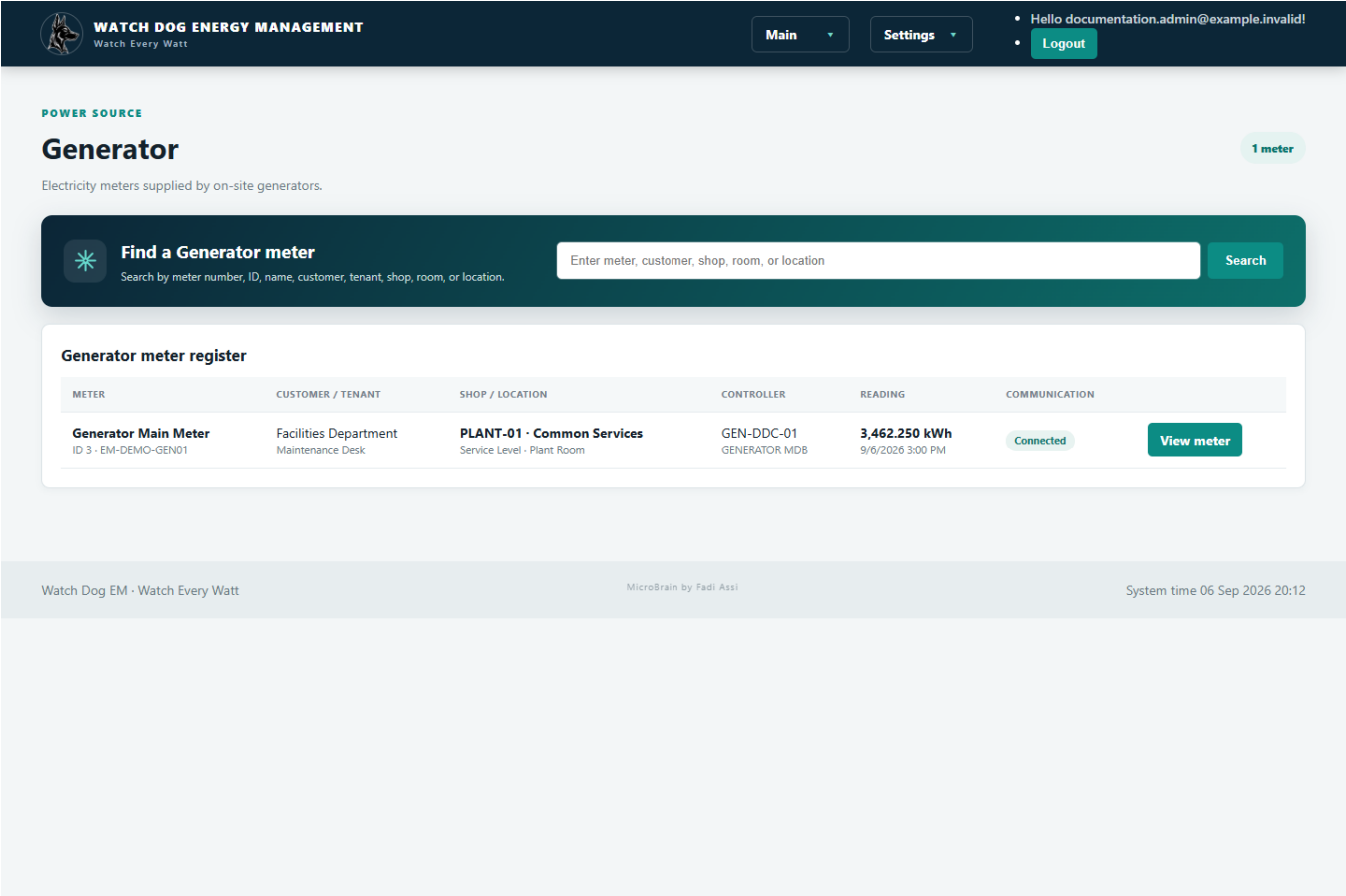


Figure 5 — Generator page: only generator-supply meters

Open Main → Grid or Main → Generator.

Search by meter ID/number, meter name, customer or tenant, shop, room or location.

Review accumulated kWh, controller, communication and latest timestamp.

Select View meter for detailed Per Day, Per Month and Per Year consumption.

Automatic placement A meter appears on the correct page according to the Power source selected when its meter record is created or edited.

Meter details and consumption

Turn cumulative meter readings into understandable hourly, daily and monthly usage.

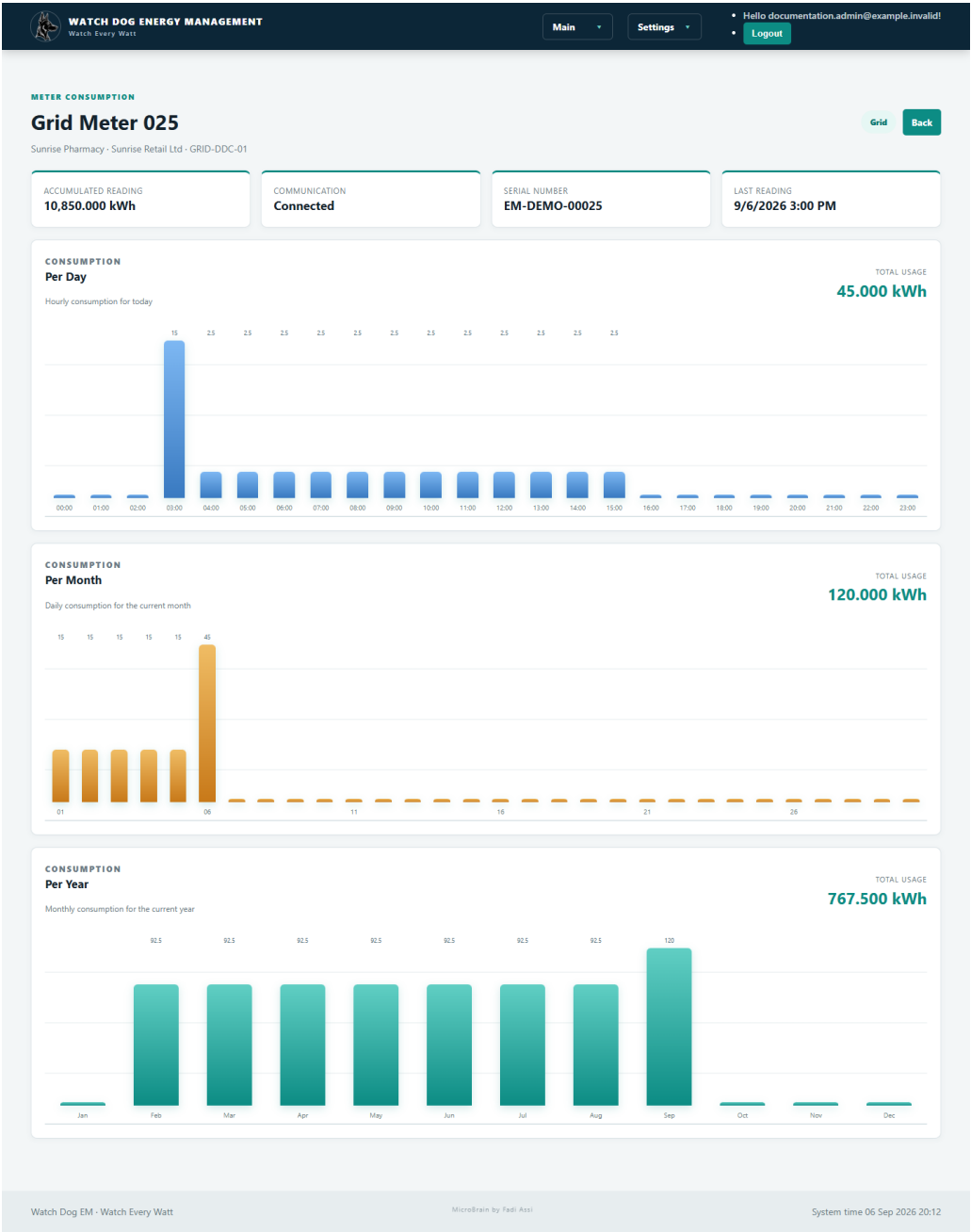


Figure 6 — Per Day, Per Month and Per Year consumption charts

How to read the charts

Chart	Each bar represents	Typical use
Per Day	Consumption during one hour	Spot daily peaks or missing intervals.
Per Month	Consumption during one day	Compare days in the current month.
Per Year	Consumption during one month	Compare seasonal/monthly patterns.

- Move the pointer over a bar to see its period, consumption and cost when a valid tariff is available.
- Totals show consumption differences between readings—not the accumulated register multiplied by tariff.

Data quality A chart needs at least two usable readings around a period. Missing bars usually mean no suitable readings, not zero consumption.

Shops, controllers and meters

Administrator commissioning sequence for a new customer meter.

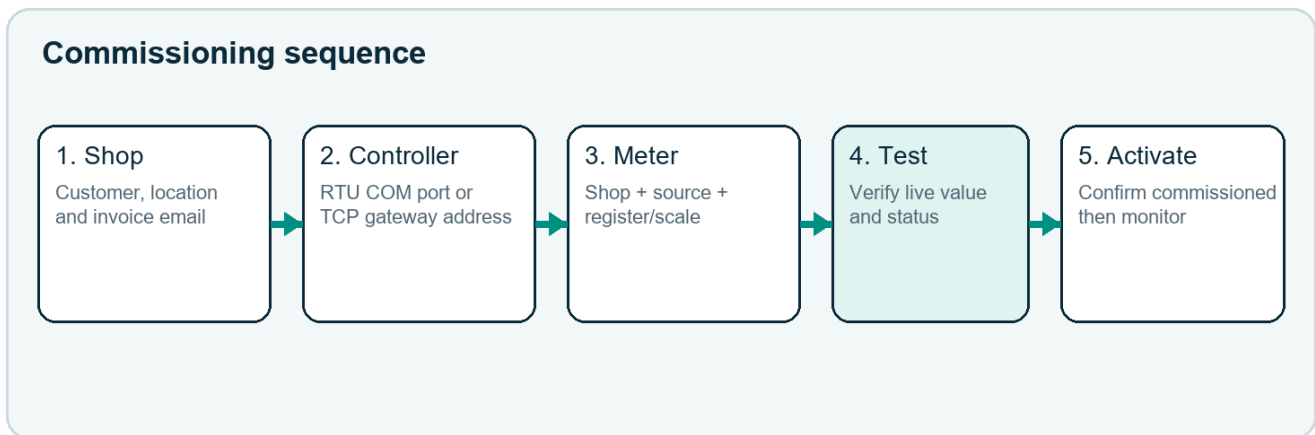


Figure 7 — Recommended order prevents missing assignments

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Main Settings Logout

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ADMINISTRATOR ONLY

Shop setup Controller setup

Create a shop before assigning meter channels.

Add shop

Shop number: SHOP-01 Shop name: Tenant name: Floor: Zone: MDB panel: Contact person: Telephone: Email: Status: Active Billing address: Tax number: Notes (optional): Reason (optional):

Add shop

Configured shops

NUMBER	NAME / TENANT	LOCATION	MDB PANEL	STATUS
--------	---------------	----------	-----------	--------

Figure 8 — Shop/customer records can be created and edited

Step 1 — Create the shop

Open Settings → Shops and choose Add shop.

Enter shop number, name, tenant/customer, contact, invoice email and location. Save.

Step 2 — Create and test the controller

Open Settings → Controller setup and choose Add controller.

Select Modbus RTU for a Windows COM port, or Modbus TCP for an IP gateway/controller.

Enter the field settings exactly as commissioned, save, then use Edit / test.

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Main ▾Settings ▾

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ADMINISTRATOR ONLY

Controller communication

+ Add controller

Add controllers and select Modbus RTU (RS-485) or Modbus TCP/IP (Ethernet). These controls are hidden from all other roles.

CONTROLLER	COMMUNICATION	CONNECTION SETTINGS	SLAVE / UNIT	CONDITION			
GEN-DDC-01 GENERATOR MDB	Modbus RTU	COM3 · 9600 · Even · 8/1	1	Connected	Edit / test	45 channels	Delete
GRID-DDC-01 MAIN MDB	Modbus RTU	COM2 · 9600 · Even · 8/1	1	Connected	Edit / test	45 channels	Delete
WATER-GW-01 WATER GATEWAY	Modbus TCP/IP	192.0.2.20:502	1	Connected	Edit / test	45 channels	Delete

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Figure 9 — Controller list and communication status

RTU versus TCP RTU uses a Windows COM port for the USB/RS-485 adapter; the DDC's physical port name does not have to equal the Windows COM number. TCP uses the controller/gateway IP address and port, normally 502.

Create and commission a meter

Every meter belongs to a shop, controller/gateway and utility/source.

Step 3 — Add the meter

From Settings → Controller setup, open the controller's meter channels or add-meter action.

Enter the meter name and actual serial number, then select the shop/customer.

For electricity choose Grid or Generator. For water choose Water when the Water feature is enabled.

Enter the register address, data type, word order and scale exactly as specified by the commissioned meter or gateway.

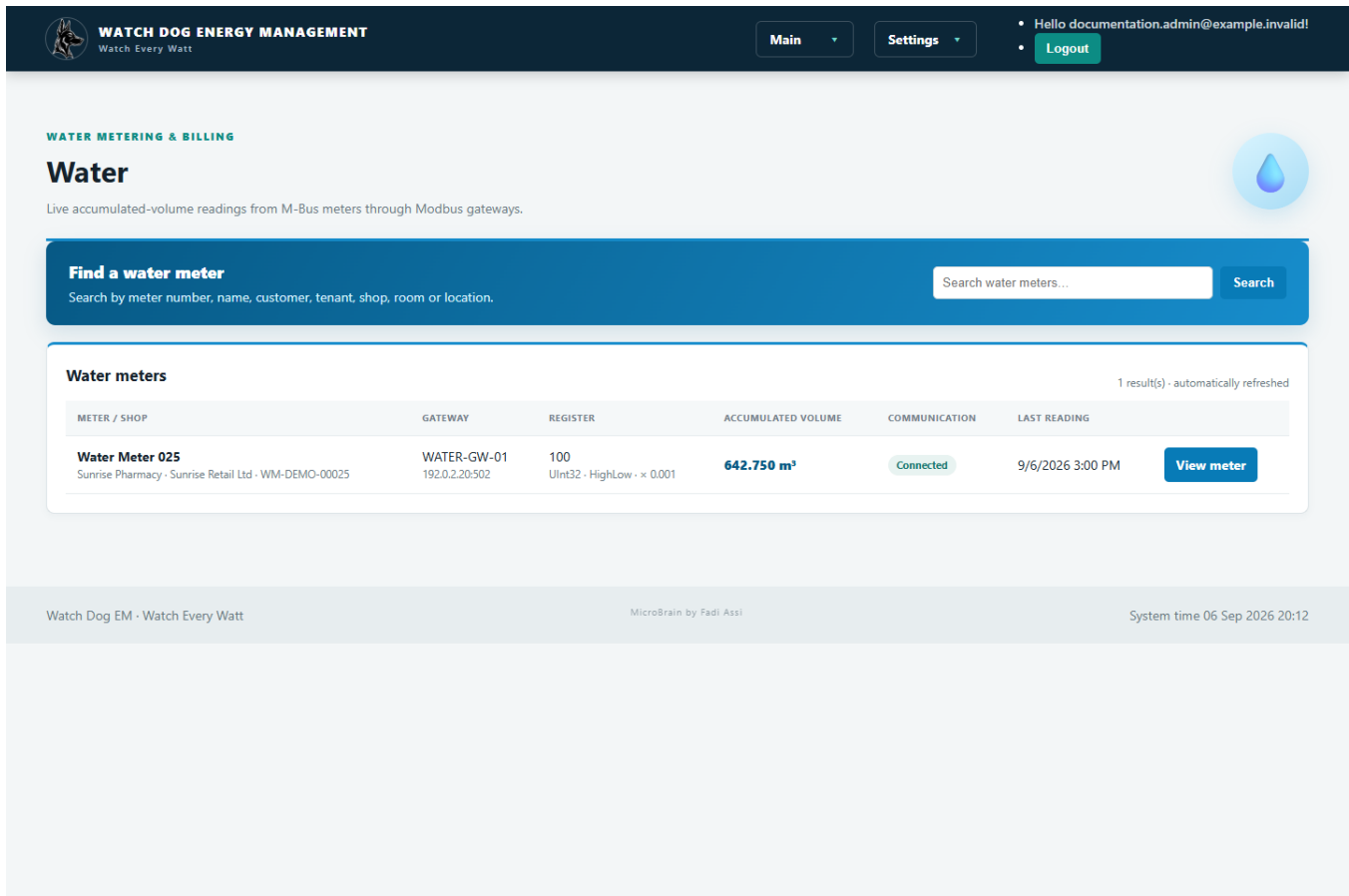
Save, test communication, confirm the displayed value against the physical meter, then activate/commission it.

Scale example A scale of 0.01 means raw register value 123456 is displayed as 1,234.56 units. Never guess the scale—use the meter/gateway register documentation and verify against the meter display.

Safety Do not mark a meter commissioned until the identifier, shop assignment, source, unit, live value and timestamp have all been checked.

Optional Water monitoring

Water pages use the same workflow with blue styling and m³ units.



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Main Settings

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WATER METERING & BILLING

Water

Live accumulated-volume readings from M-Bus meters through Modbus gateways.

Find a water meter
Search by meter number, name, customer, tenant, shop, room or location.

Search water meters... Search

Water meters 1 result(s) - automatically refreshed

METER / SHOP	GATEWAY	REGISTER	ACCUMULATED VOLUME	COMMUNICATION	LAST READING
Water Meter 025 Sunrise Pharmacy · Sunrise Retail Ltd · WM-DEMO-00025	WATER-GW-01 192.0.2.20:502	100 UInt32 · HighLow · x 0.001	642.750 m³	Connected	9/6/2026 3:00 PM

View meter

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Figure 10 — Optional Water page with a Modbus TCP gateway

- Enable Water in Settings → System features only when water meters are part of the installation.
- An M-Bus meter may connect to an M-Bus-to-Modbus TCP gateway; Watch Dog reads the mapped Modbus value directly.
- Create the gateway as Modbus TCP, then create each water meter with its gateway unit/slave ID, register, data type, word order and scale.

Commissioning check Compare Watch Dog m³ with the physical water meter. Confirm that the gateway exposes a cumulative volume register and not an instantaneous flow register.

Tariffs and monthly publication

One tariff and currency per meter; one selected publication day per meter schedule.

Tariff and monthly invoice publication

Meter

Select meter

Tariff price

Currency

UGX

Invoice publication day

Select day 1-7

Payment due after (days)

10

Reason (optional)

The tariff starts immediately for the selected meter. Every month, invoices for the previous completed month are published on the selected day.

Save all settings

Current schedule: day 1 of every month · next publication 01 Oct 2026 · payment due after 10 days

Previous tariff and schedule changes are available only in [Audit trail](#).

Figure 11 — Tariff and monthly invoice publication settings

- Open Main → Operations and expand Tariff and monthly invoice publication.
- Select the meter and enter its price per kWh (or m³ for water) and ISO currency.
- Select an invoice publication day from 1 to 7 and enter the payment due interval in days.
- Choose Save all settings. The tariff starts immediately for future consumption calculations.
- On the scheduled day, Watch Dog publishes the previous completed calendar month when it is running.
 - Each meter can have a different tariff, currency, publication day and due interval.

Example A meter scheduled for day 6 with 10 due days publishes August consumption on 6 September and sets the due date 10 days later. It does not invoice accumulated lifetime kWh.

Reading history and data export

Verify collected evidence before investigating billing or communication.

Reading history					
TIMESTAMP	METER	RAW	ACCUMULATED	SOURCE	QUALITY
9/6/2026 3:00 PM	Water Meter 025 Water	64275	642.750 m³	Automatic	Good
9/5/2026 3:00 PM	Water Meter 025 Water	64000	640.000 m³	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 3:00 PM	Generator Main Meter Electricity	346225	3,462.250 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/5/2026 3:00 PM	Generator Main Meter Electricity	344000	3,440.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 3:00 PM	Grid Meter 108 Electricity	782550	7,825.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/5/2026 3:00 PM	Grid Meter 108 Electricity	780000	7,800.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 3:00 PM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1085000	10,850.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 2:00 PM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1084750	10,847.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 1:00 PM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1084500	10,845.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 12:00 PM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1084250	10,842.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 11:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1084000	10,840.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 10:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1083750	10,837.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 9:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1083500	10,835.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 8:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1083250	10,832.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 7:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1083000	10,830.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 6:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1082750	10,827.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 5:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1082500	10,825.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 4:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1082250	10,822.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1082000	10,820.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/6/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1083000	10,830.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/5/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1081500	10,815.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/4/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1080000	10,800.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/3/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1078500	10,785.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/2/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1077000	10,770.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
9/1/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1075500	10,755.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
8/1/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1074000	10,740.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
7/1/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1064750	10,647.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
6/1/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1055500	10,555.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
5/1/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1046250	10,462.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
4/1/2026 3:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1037000	10,370.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
3/1/2026 2:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1027750	10,277.500 kWh	Automatic	Good
2/1/2026 2:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1018500	10,185.000 kWh	Automatic	Good
1/1/2026 2:00 AM	Grid Meter 025 Electricity	1009250	10,092.500 kWh	Automatic	Good

Figure 12 — Reading history can be folded to keep Operations compact

- Filter readings by date/meter where controls are available, and use the latest timestamps to confirm collection continuity.
- Export readings to CSV for external review or reconciliation.
- A valid reading includes meter identity, timestamp, value and quality/state. Invalid or repeated data should be investigated before billing.

Purpose Reading history is the evidence behind consumption differences and invoices. The Audit trail records user/configuration events; it is not a substitute for meter readings.

Published invoices

Search, review, download, print and record payment against published invoices.

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Main ▾Settings ▾

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• [Logout](#)

BILLING ARCHIVE

Published invoices

Every finalized monthly invoice is saved here for viewing and PDF download.

 **Find an invoice**
Search by day, month, year, invoice number, shop, tenant or meter.

Example: 01, September 2026, SHOP-01 or tenant name

Search

Invoice archive

1 result(s)

INVOICE	SHOP / METER	PUBLISHED	DUE DATE	STATUS	TOTAL	BALANCE	
INV-000001	Sunrise Pharmacy Sunrise Retail Ltd - Grid Meter 025 - Grid	01 Sep 2026	11 Sep 2026	Finalized	UGX 807,500.00	UGX 807,500.00	View / PDF

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Figure 13 — Searchable invoice archive

Open Main → Published invoices.

Search by day, month, year, shop/tenant, meter or invoice number.

Select View / PDF, confirm the billing period, readings, tariff, charges, total and balance.



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Main

Settings

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Logout

ELECTRICITY INVOICE

INV-000001

Sunrise Pharmacy - Finalized

Download PDF

Print preview

Email PDF invoice

SMTP invoice email is disabled. An Administrator can configure and activate it in [Settings -> Invoice email](#).

Mall Utility Metering & Billing

Due 11 Sep 2026

Billed to

Sunrise Pharmacy
Shop SHOP-025
Tenant: Sunrise Retail Ltd

Meter

Grid Meter 025
EM-DEMO-00025
Utility: Electricity
Power source: Grid
MAIN MDB

PREVIOUS READING	CURRENT READING	CONSUMPTION	TARIFF
10,000.00 kWh	10,850.00 kWh	850.00 kWh	UGX 950,000 / kWh
Electricity charge			UGX 807,500.00
Fixed and additional charges			UGX 0.00
Tax			UGX 0.00
Discount			- UGX 0.00
Previous balance			UGX 0.00

TOTAL AMOUNT DUE

UGX 807,500.00

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Figure 14 — Invoice detail and PDF/email actions

- Download PDF creates the customer document. Print preview uses the browser print workflow.
- Authorized staff can record payments from Operations; status changes to partially paid or paid according to the remaining balance.

Before delivery Confirm customer name/email, meter serial number, period, opening and closing readings, tariff/currency, due date and total.

Invoice email (optional)

Use the customer's SMTP provider; the feature is disabled by default.

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Main Settings Logout

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ADMINISTRATOR ONLY

Invoice email

Optionally send published PDF invoices through the customer's SMTP provider.

SMTP configuration

Disabled by default. The password is encrypted for this Windows installation and is never displayed again. After a successful test, the settings and password are saved automatically.

☐ Enable PDF invoice email ☐ Automatically email every newly published invoice

SMTP server: smtp.example.com

Port: 587 ☒ Use SSL/TLS (STARTTLS)

SMTP username:

SMTP password or app password: Enter SMTP password Sender email: billing@example.com Sender name: Watch Dog EM

Test recipient: your-email@example.com

Standard email message: Please find your utility invoice attached. Thank you for your business.

Dear customer and the invoice number, total, due date and PDF attachment are added automatically.

Global control: turn on both switches to email every customer automatically at the end of the billing period. Turn off automatic delivery to keep the manual email button only, or turn off PDF invoice email to disable all sending.

Save SMTP settings Save and send test email

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Figure 15 — SMTP settings and global automatic-delivery switch

Open Settings → Invoice email as Administrator.

Enter SMTP server, port, SSL/TLS mode, username, app password, sender name/email and a test recipient.

Write the standard customer message. Watch Dog adds the greeting, invoice details and PDF attachment.

Choose Save and send test email. Confirm receipt before enabling automatic delivery.

Enable PDF invoice email. Also enable Automatically email every newly published invoice only when the customer wants automatic delivery.

Password behavior The SMTP/app password is encrypted for this Windows installation and is not displayed again. Leave the password box blank when changing other settings; enter a new value only to replace it.

If test email fails Check internet access, SMTP host/port, SSL/TLS, username, app-password validity, sender permission, antivirus/firewall and the provider's sent/spam logs.

Users, access and audit

Give every person the minimum access needed and keep changes attributable.

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Main Settings

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Logout

ADMINISTRATOR ONLY

Users & Access

Create user accounts and assign one access level to each user.

Add new user

The username and password are used to sign in. Email is stored only as contact information.

Username:

Email: (Information only (optional))

Access level:

Temporary password:

Confirm password:

Create user

User access levels

USERNAME	EMAIL INFORMATION	CURRENT ACCESS	NEW ACCESS LEVEL
documentation.admin@example.invalid Current account	documentation.admin@example.invalid	Administrator	Administrator Save access Delete

Access level permissions

ACCESS LEVEL	PERMISSION
Administrator	Full system configuration, controllers, meters, shops, billing, users, audit, backup and restore.
Billing Manager	Create, finalize and manage billing periods and invoices.
Operator	Operational pages and meter monitoring without administrator configuration.
Viewer	View permitted dashboards and operational information.

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Figure 16 — Users & Access is managed by an Administrator

Open Settings → Users & Access, enter username, optional information email, access level and a temporary password.

Create the user and give credentials securely. Test the account before operational handover.

Delete accounts that are no longer required only after confirming the exact user.

Role	Use
Administrator	System setup, communication, users, SMTP, backup and all operations.
Billing Manager	Tariffs, invoices and payment operations.
Operator	Daily monitoring and permitted operating tasks.
Viewer	Read-only monitoring.

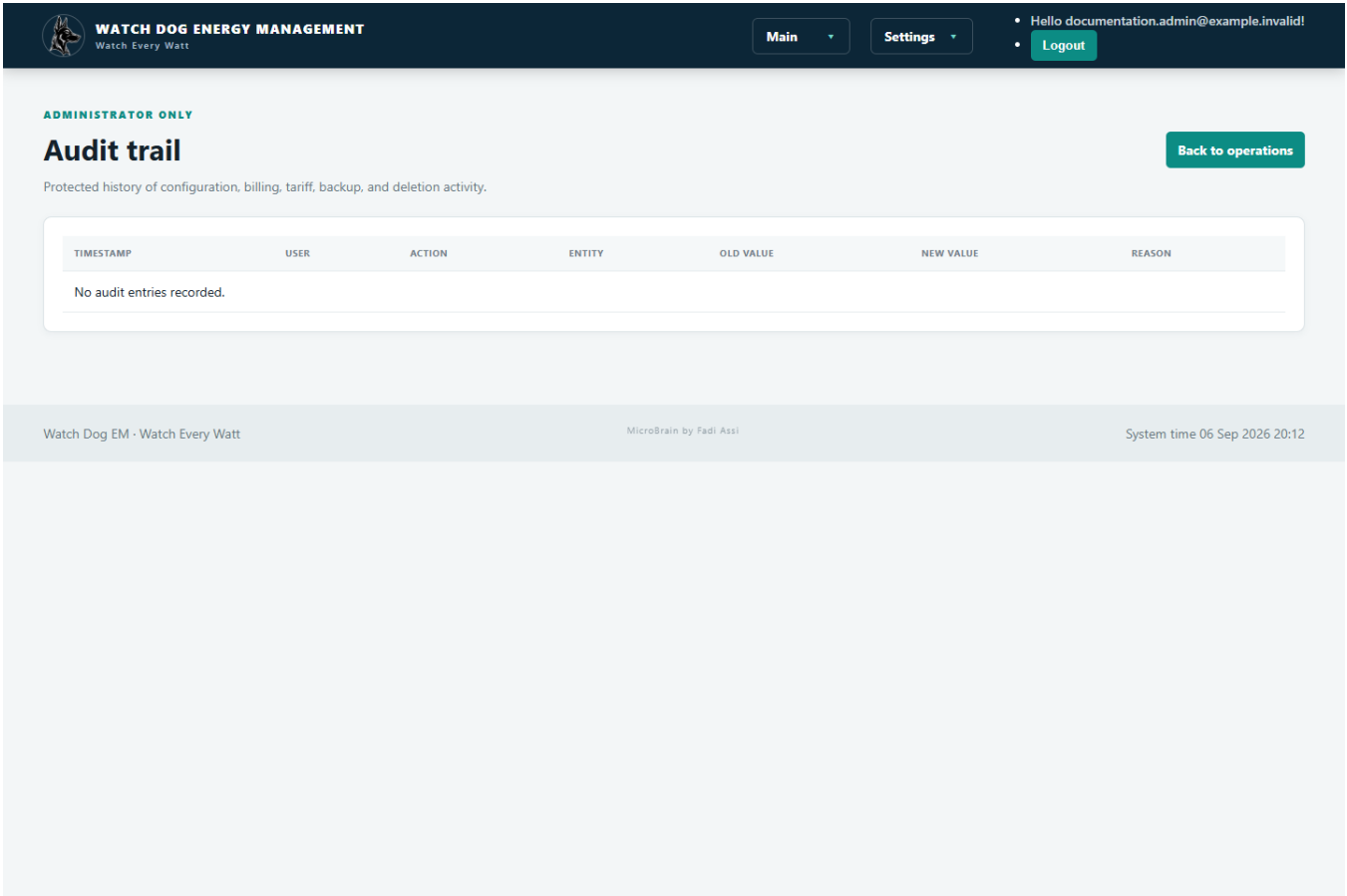


Figure 17 — Audit trail keeps administrative and billing changes separate from daily screens

System features, backup and restore

Optional modules can be hidden; configuration and billing data must be protected.

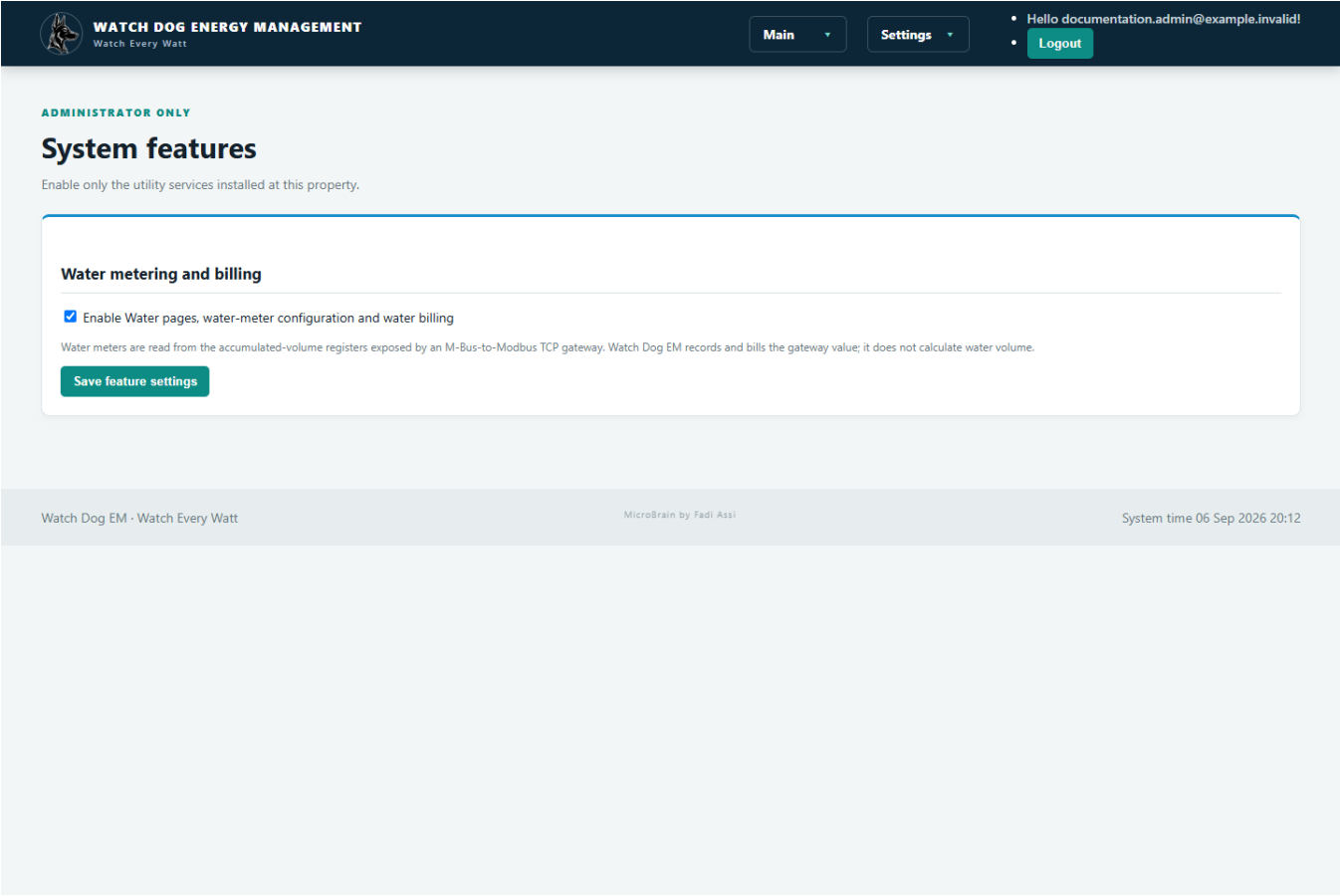


Figure 18 — Enable Water only when required

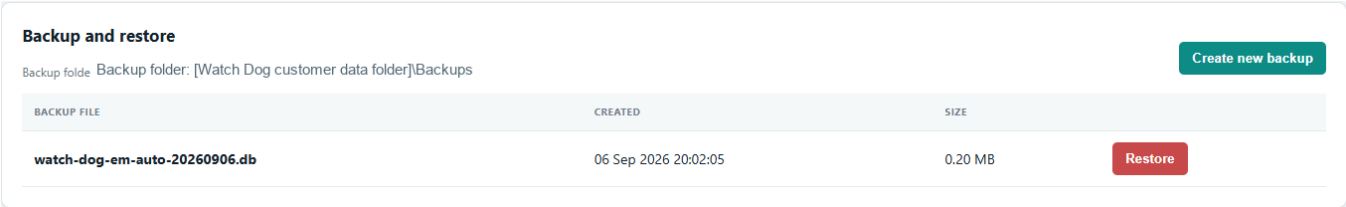


Figure 19 — Backup and restore controls in Operations

Create a backup after successful commissioning and before major configuration or software changes.
Copy approved backups to a separate protected drive or server according to the customer's policy.
Use Restore only as Administrator, select the correct backup, and verify shops, meters, readings and invoices afterwards.

Restore warning Restore changes system data. Stop routine changes, identify the exact backup and ensure a separate current backup exists before proceeding.

LAN browser access

Other computers monitor the exact same Watch Dog database through the main PC.

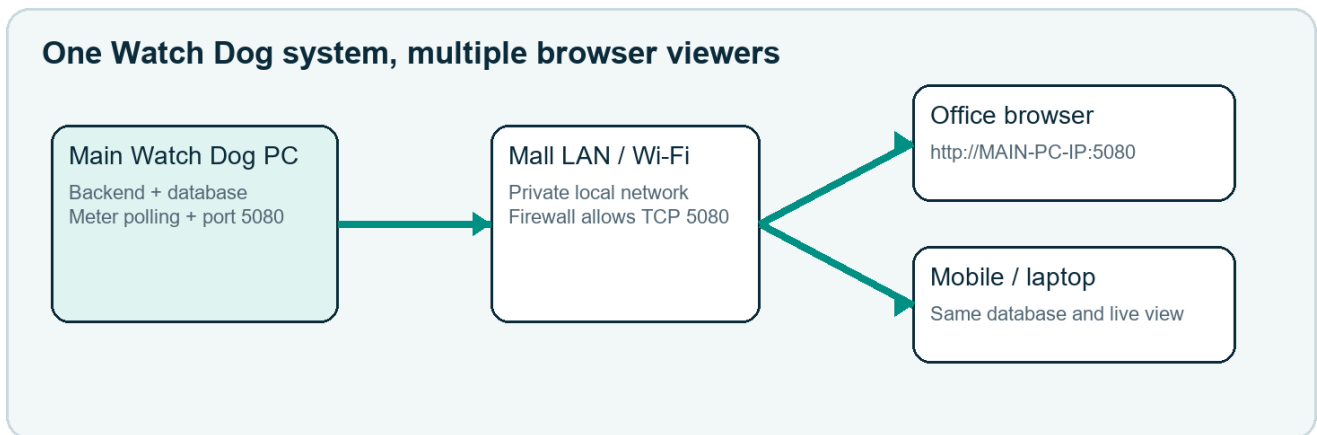


Figure 20 — Browser clients do not poll meters or run another backend

Give the main Watch Dog PC a stable LAN address, for example 192.168.16.201, using a DHCP reservation or careful static configuration.

On the main PC, confirm `http://localhost:5080` opens and Windows Firewall has an inbound TCP rule for port 5080 on the Private profile.

From a second device on the same LAN/Wi-Fi, open `http://MAIN-PC-IP:5080`—for example `http://192.168.16.201:5080`.

If it fails, verify both devices are on the same subnet, the network profile is Private, client isolation is off, and ping/routing/firewall policy allows access.

Architecture Only the main PC communicates with the DDC/PLC/gateways. Multiple browsers share the same web server and database; they do not create additional polling services.

Daily operating checklist

A short routine for the operator at the start and end of each shift.

Start of day

- Main PC is powered, awake and connected to the LAN and field communication adapters.
- Watch Dog opens at localhost:5080.
- Meters Online and Meter Alarms are reviewed.
- Grid, Generator and enabled Water pages show recent timestamps.
- Any offline or stale meter is recorded and investigated.

Billing-day check

- Published invoice archive contains the expected period and shops.
- Invoices have correct opening/closing readings, tariff, currency and due date.
- Automatic email results are checked when enabled; failed deliveries are handled manually.
- Payments entered by staff reconcile with the remaining balances.

End of day / weekly

- Communication alarms are resolved or handed over.
- Audit trail is reviewed for unexpected configuration changes.
- A recent verified backup exists outside the main PC.

Troubleshooting

Use evidence first; change configuration only when the fault is identified.

Symptom	Check	Action
Not commissioned	Controller/meter enabled, communication test and activation	Test settings, compare the live value, then confirm commissioning.
No communication	Windows COM/IP, wiring, polarity, baud/parity/slave or TCP route/port	Match field settings exactly; ensure no second program owns the COM port.
Connected but value does not change	Timestamp, meter display and actual load	Wait for load/change; verify the correct cumulative register and scale.
No invoice	Schedule day, app uptime, readings around month boundary, tariff	Keep main PC awake/running; verify two suitable readings and active tariff.
Email test fails	SMTP/app password, TLS, port, internet and provider policy	Re-enter new app password, save-and-test, check provider logs.
Second PC cannot open	Main PC IP, port 5080, Private firewall rule, Wi-Fi isolation	Test localhost first, then http://MAIN-PC-IP:5080 .
Charts empty	Insufficient historical reading points	Confirm timestamps and allow readings to accumulate.
Water page missing	Feature disabled	Administrator enables Water in System features.

Escalate with evidence Provide the exact meter/controller, timestamp, visible status, recent change, and screenshot. Never send passwords or unredacted customer secrets.

FAQ and handover

Answers to common customer questions.

Does each meter have its own tariff?

Yes. Select the meter, price and currency in Operations. Tariff history is retained through the audit trail.

Does the tariff date create the invoice?

The current workflow uses a monthly publication day from 1–7. The tariff becomes active immediately; the schedule publishes the previous completed month.

Why is accumulated kWh larger than the monthly bill usage?

Accumulated reading is the lifetime register. Invoice consumption is closing minus opening reading for the billing period.

Can Grid and Generator meters use different prices?

Yes. Tariff and currency are saved per meter.

Can customers view from a phone?

Yes, on the same LAN/Wi-Fi using the main PC IP and port 5080, subject to login and network policy.

Does every browser communicate with the PLC?

No. One background service on the main PC polls meters; browsers only view the same application.

What happens if the PC sleeps?

Polling and scheduled work cannot run while Windows is asleep. Keep the main PC powered and configure an appropriate no-sleep policy.

Can an invoice be emailed automatically?

Yes, when SMTP is correctly tested and both PDF invoice email and automatic delivery are enabled.

What should be backed up?

Use Watch Dog's backup function; retain protected copies away from the main PC and test restore procedures.

Customer handover record

Item	Confirmed by / date
Main PC and LAN URL	
Administrator account issued securely	
Controllers and meters tested	
Tariffs and schedules approved	
SMTP test received (if enabled)	
Backup created and copied	
Operator training completed	

Support boundary Field wiring, meter programming, Windows/network policy and SMTP provider accounts remain site/customer responsibilities unless included in a separate support agreement.